

Wrist Injury - Male (Child)

Algorithm 1307 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Male

Definition

- Wrist injury assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published broken arm or wrist guidance.
- Child patient.
- Male.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] How did the injury happen?
2. [YES_NO] Any numbness or tingling in the hand?
3. [DURATION] When did it happen?
4. [OPEN_TEXT] Record open wound, bleeding, hand colour/warmth/movement, rings, crush or high-energy mechanism, age, pregnancy, anticoagulants, immune suppression, and safeguarding concern.
5. [YES_NO] If the patient is under 18, can they speak privately now, is the accompanying caregiver considered safe, and is there an approved safe callback method if contact is lost?
6. [CAREGIVER_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Motor Vehicle Accident

Was the wrist injury part of a motor vehicle crash or other multi-system collision?

A motor vehicle collision requires the Motor Vehicle Accident pathway before an isolated wrist pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

If the patient is under 18, is harm occurring now, is there immediate danger from an accompanying or suspected caregiver, could the child be returned now to an unsafe person or place, or did contact end while an immediate threat remained unresolved?

Immediate danger, ongoing harm, an imminent unsafe return, or loss of contact during an unresolved immediate threat requires emergency action. Qatar 999 is the verified emergency route. Exact child-protection reporting, consent, documentation, and information-sharing requirements are GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED.

2. Disposition level 78

If the patient is under 18 and there is no confirmed immediate danger, are they unable to speak privately, is caregiver safety uncertain, or is there another safeguarding concern requiring trained assessment?

An inability to obtain a private history, uncertainty about caregiver safety, or another safeguarding concern needs prompt trained assessment without automatically treating it as a confirmed emergency. The exact Qatar safeguarding pathway is GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED.

3. Disposition level 100

Is there major deformity, exposed bone, uncontrolled bleeding, severe crush injury, or is the hand pale/blue/cold, pulseless, numb, weak, or unable to move?

NHS.UK broken arm or wrist guidance lists visible deformity, protruding bone, and loss of feeling or circulation as emergency-assessment criteria.

3. Disposition level 70

Is there significant swelling, inability to move the wrist normally, or pain that worsens when trying to grip or move it?

NHS.UK guidance lists these signs as reasons to seek urgent medical assessment for a possible fracture.

3. Disposition level 15

Is this a minor bump or strain with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance describes minor wrist injuries as manageable at home with rest, ice, and pain relief.

Advice

Immediate child safeguarding danger

- Call Qatar 999 now when immediate danger or ongoing harm is suspected. If contact continues, confirm the child's current location and a safe way to communicate without alerting or confronting a suspected unsafe caregiver. If contact is lost, use only the approved safe callback method and follow the governance-approved emergency escalation process. Do not promise confidentiality. Exact Qatar child-protection reporting, consent, documentation, and information-sharing rules are GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: harm occurring now or immediate danger; imminent return to an unsafe person or place; contact lost while an immediate threat remains unresolved.

Urgent private child safeguarding assessment

- Keep questions neutral and seek a private conversation only when it is safe. Do not disclose sensitive information to a caregiver whose safety is uncertain, do not confront or alert a suspected unsafe person, and do not promise confidentiality. Arrange prompt in-person assessment through the governance-approved Qatar child safeguarding pathway and record only an approved safe callback method. If immediate danger emerges

or contact is lost during an unresolved immediate threat, use the emergency branch and call Qatar 999. Exact reporting, consent, documentation, and information-sharing rules are GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED.

- Call Back If: private history cannot be obtained safely; caregiver safety remains uncertain; new immediate danger or loss of contact.

Emergency wrist injury precautions

- Call Qatar 999 now. Do not realign or test the wrist. Support it as found, cover exposed bone loosely, control bleeding around it, remove rings if easy, and do not allow self-driving. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: hand becomes pale, blue, cold, pulseless, numb, or weak; worsening bleeding, swelling, or severe pain.

Prompt in-person wrist assessment

- Use the Qatar governance-approved in-person pathway. Support the wrist without forcing position and use a wrapped cool pack. Medication must account for age, pregnancy, kidney disease, bleeding risk, and doses already taken.
- Call Back If: increasing pain or swelling, numbness, weakness, or colour/temperature change.

Care for a clearly minor wrist injury

- Rest from aggravating activity, use a wrapped cool pack briefly, and confirm pain medicine with a pharmacist. Seek review if function does not improve or any neurovascular symptom develops.
- Call Back If: pain or swelling worsens, grip weakens, or numbness or colour change develops.

First aid

- Call Qatar 999 now when immediate danger or ongoing harm is suspected. If contact continues, confirm the child's current location and a safe way to communicate without alerting or confronting a suspected unsafe caregiver. If contact is lost, use only the approved safe callback method and follow the governance-approved emergency escalation process. Do not promise confidentiality. Exact Qatar child-protection reporting, consent, documentation, and information-sharing rules are GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
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References

- NHS.UK, "Broken arm or wrist", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/broken-arm-or-wrist/>

Provenance

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